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REAWAKENING FROM DELIBERATE ANESTHESIA THROUGH FOCUSING ON THE INNER VOICES

Greetings. Loving blessings are pouring forth for every one of you here. Welcome, my dearest friends. Let us continue with this specific series of lectures. And keep in mind, my friends, that they are a sequence, one leading to the next on the spiral of your evolutionary process commensurate with your increasing awareness.

In this particular lecture I will again speak about the phenomenon of consciousness, particularly in connection with the evolutionary process and the meaning of individual life. This will be focused in a very particular way, as you will see.

All the knowledge is in you. I have often said this, but very rarely is it truly understood. As you are born into this life, a process of anesthesia sets in. There is a very specific reason for this. You awaken, as you come out of infancy, with a limited consciousness. That is, the awakening is partial and gradual. As you grow physically, mentally, and emotionally in this lifetime, you grope and rediscover knowledge. At first you do this only in a very limited way, geared only to material life. You learn to walk, to handle objects, to speak. You learn reading, writing, numbers, and certain basic laws of outer life, of the life of matter that surrounds you and that you must learn to handle.

Once that basic material knowledge is mastered, or reawakened, deeper knowledge is reacquired, provided that the growth process takes place as planned. When a person is in an intensive growing process, this will be so in ever increasing depth and scope. However, if the person has stopped his movement, his life train, he will also prevent the reacquisition of knowledge that he potentially possesses.

Inevitably, here you will have to ask your first question: "Why does anesthesia set in? Why is it handled that way?" The anesthesia actually sets in quite a while prior to the process of birth. When, in your spiritual reality where the total entity that you are truly belongs, you have decided upon a reappearance in this dimension, you will be deliberately anesthetized. After all plans have been thoroughly discussed and assimilated, you will lose consciousness. A person who undergoes an operation on the material plane goes through a similar process. In fact, the process of anesthetization is "copied," remembered, rediscovered. Only its purpose on earth is to prevent pain during the necessary operation. In the case of the incarnatory process, the reason is a different one. I will talk about this shortly.

Before the spiritual self takes possession of the human body in the birth process, the entity is already in a sleeping state, in an anesthetized, unaware state. When the birth process takes place, there is an awakening to a very slight degree -- that is, in relation to its actual state. The limited part of the entity that takes possession of the infant body finds itself awake to some extent, to the extent

of certain physical functioning, of physical sensations and certain very limited functions of perception and awareness, but these cannot be properly assessed, interpreted, and assimilated. That comes later. So the state of awareness after birth is increased as compared to the state before birth, but it is still a very limited state of awareness. And, as I said before, the process of becoming more aware and awake is a very gradual one as growth and expansion in life proceeds.

The first years -- I would say perhaps, roughly, the first twenty-two to twenty-five years, although this cannot be generalized -- are primarily geared to acquiring outer knowledge. After this period, provided the process is meaningful and organic, the focus should go into acquiring inner, spiritual knowledge, knowledge that transcends the physical reality. This can take place first on a psychological level. I include psychological knowledge when I speak of inner, spiritual knowledge. For psychological knowledge deals with the laws and processes of the inner self. Of course, it overlaps. With certain individuals who are highly developed, who are more capable of spiritual fulfillment, the awakening to inner reality occurs often, though not always, in an earlier period and coincides with the outer learning. So, for example, you have children on your path who begin, to some degree, already early in life to acquire and comprehend some inner knowledge. This can happen because this knowledge is so very near and so deeply anchored into the soul; because in previous lifetimes it has become such an integral part of the entity that it is much easier and faster to reawaken than it is for others who have not yet gone through such development and who must still go through certain processes of growing, searching, and struggling before the inner knowledge has penetrated every particle of the soul. And that is of course what life is all about. For all these are necessary: the groping process, the process of trial and error, searching, often being confused and not knowing and dealing with the not knowing in the most constructive way, finding the often precarious balance between patience and humility for the grace of knowledge to communicate itself, on the one hand, and between serious commitment, endeavor, focus, consolidated will, and healthy aggression extended toward this process, on the other. In this process lies the key. When the lessons of these endeavors are being absorbed by the soul, the reacquisition of knowledge will come much more easily in a future lifetime, if I am to use your terminology regarding time.

I will now return to the question about why the temporary anesthetizing takes place. Perhaps a part of the answer has already dawned on you by the foregoing, but I shall try to go deeper. Even though it is not easy to convey these principles, I shall do the best I can. I recapitulate briefly. Whether a soul has already gone through the process described and thus spiritual knowledge, understanding, and perception are natural even in the limited state of the human embodiment; whether this has not yet taken place at all; or whether a soul is within this very process and continues it life after life -- in all these instances alike, to begin with, the manifest personality does not know what it knows. Knowledge, to whatever degree it exists, is blotted out, "forgotten," as it were. So whatever state of development you may be in, you start off with a clean slate, you start off knowing nothing, whether you are highly developed or whether the process is still on a lower scale. So, to begin with, the knowledge that is in you is apparently not in you. Now, why must that be?

Here I must recapitulate a recent lecture I gave about the evolutionary process (Lecture No. 218). I discussed how the "mass" of consciousness spreads, filling the void. As it does so, particles of consciousness lose themselves. The essential divine consciousness, in its beauty, wisdom, and benign power, functions in a limited and distorted way. That isolated particle must seek its way to unite again with the forward rushing, spreading movement of the divine state of life that inexorably fills the void. In this process, the separated particles -- individual entities -- must find the way back

on their own, by dint of reawakening the divine potentials that are always present, even in the most separated aspects.

I bring back this analogy again and again ever since I gave that lecture, in order to make you understand the topic in question. In this particular case, that part of your soul that is still separated must forget whatever it has known in a more awake state in order for the undeveloped part to find its own way.

Now let me try to make this clear. Let us suppose you would consciously know now all that you deeply know. Then the undeveloped aspects in you would not find under their own steam, their essence, their innate essence. These aspects would be swept along, as it were, by the already knowing aspects, by the already developed aspects. They would therefore always be unreliable. They would essentially, although not necessarily manifestly, blur the beauty, the vitality, the creativity, and the wisdom. They would be swept along in the surge of the total glory of God consciousness, but they would not be totally infused with it. Purification and evolution mean that every smallest aspect of all that is must be infused with its own essence.

Just let us apply this somewhat metaphysical, philosophical, and general explanation to your present state, to your everyday life and struggle on your path. You will then perhaps not only understand better what I said, you will also benefit from it and find considerable aid in this explanation. On your path you constantly discover aspects of negativity, of irrationality, of childishness, of selfishness, of destructiveness. You also know that these aspects flare up at an early state of your development by themselves without provocation from outside. They are so strong that you initiate them regardless of what the outer situation is like. But as your development proceeds, this is no longer the case. The negative aspects cease to manifest by themselves. They need outer provocation. You respond with them to the initiating negativity of others around you. However, you do live in the world of matter in which, even under the best of circumstances, life is not easy. Matter obstructs and frustrates so that the very fact of living in this dimension of reality (which is your production, of course) is always a challenge. Imagine that you would live under circumstances so sublime and favorable, so desirable and bliss-producing that even the worst in you could and would not find occasion to express itself. It is easy to see that then it would remain dormant and unexposed and thus could not go through its necessary process of purification.

You are often convinced, and partially rightly so, that if others would not do this or that, you would be fine, you would stay in a state of harmony and bliss. The blurred areas in you would, however, continue to smolder because without their manifestation you would not know of their existence. They need exactly the triggering off, the exposure, and the provocation. By the same token, if you would consciously know all you know, just as if there were no provocations from outside, the undeveloped aspects would not flare up and would not acquire their own ingrained knowing. They would merely be affected by what the already developed aspects know.

You have also experienced on your path that when you successfully work through those blurred areas, you become absolutely safe no matter what others do or fail to do, no matter how they react. You remain essentially whole and essentially unaffected. I do not mean unaffected in a sense of being remote and feelingless. I mean that the particular negativity in you that you have worked through no longer exists and therefore cannot flare up when others do wrong by you. You may be hurt or angry but in an entirely different way than when your own unresolved faults and

flaws are triggered off by outside circumstances. So you no longer depend on perfection in order not to face your imperfection. The effect of others' destructiveness will not make you lose your bearing or make you uncentered if your blurred areas have been purified, clarified, cleansed, eliminated.

The same principle prevails in regard to the relationship between your own inner imperfections and already purified parts. If you were born knowing all you know, the uncleansed areas would depend on the cleansed ones and not become whole within themselves; while if the wise, knowing, enlightened aspects of yourself are asleep, that sleep is necessary so that blurred areas struggle through on their own, with the aid of the knowledge that is essentially in you. Thus out of the lack of knowledge, knowledge is being developed. Out of the darkness, light is being developed, because even in the darkest and most ignorant part there is the essence of knowledge and light. That essence must come from within itself rather than from that aspect outside of itself that already possesses wisdom and light. So then, when the knowledge and light are brought forth from within your own limitations and blurred state, purification is thorough, reliable, and real. Then true independence from surroundings is being established, and thus true freedom. Then each particle, each aspect of consciousness has brought forth its own "minuscule Godness," if I may use this expression. And that is the meaning of the anesthesia with which you enter into life. Your struggle for your essential light gradually and surely diminishes the anesthesia and awakens you to who you really are.

You also experience on your path that the more courage you muster to face your truth, the more humility and honesty you bring to bear on your whole inner person, the more alert and awake you become. This is an inexorable by-product that cannot fail to manifest. You suddenly, or gradually, see, understand, and perceive others in a way you could never do before. You begin to recognize others' negativities without being personally affected and upset. You no longer struggle against others' negativity in a blind, resentful way without really seeing clearly, only vaguely perceiving as through a fog. You see really clearly; you comprehend intuitively the connections that make the transgression no longer a personal annihilation. Thus you also begin to see and perceive others' beauty in a way that fails to make you jealous but that fills you with awe, wonder, and gratitude. You begin to perceive connections of interactions between you and others that eliminate the riddle of life and of living with others and that increases your security because you see and know the processes in human interaction. And as you go on in that way, dealing with and eliminating your own impurities, suddenly, or gradually, a new focusing and awareness awaken inside of you. A knowledge flows into you, apparently from out of nowhere. It is not from the brain. It is not from the outer knowledge you have acquired in the first two decades of your life or later. It has nothing to do with what you have learned. It comes from a different source.

As channels open, a new focusing can set in. You can begin very deliberately to listen into the inner universe from where all wisdom flows into your outer being. This is a gradual process, yet it is also often sudden in its manifestation. It is a process that is interrupted, that seems to disappear at the beginning of its initial manifestations so that the experience seems to have been a dream. It is a state that must be fought for in a positive, relaxed sense. It must be gained and regained, as it is lost over and over again.

This focusing must be done quite deliberately after a certain stage of development and purification. The focusing will yield to connections, to listening and "hearing." Now, the state of

consciousness of humanity as a whole makes such focusing quite impossible. This is a result of mass conditioning. Thus, even those who would essentially be developed enough to do so don't even try. Their still unresolved problem may be fear of ridicule and disapproval from the world around them, and the courage is lacking to establish the inner self as the center of individual life. The whole of humanity is conditioned in such a way as to focus only on certain phenomena outside and inside, at the exclusion of other aspects of reality until only that which is in focus seems real. Thus a whole world exists around you that you simply do not see and experience, that seems like a fantasy of others when it is being discussed. This limitation of perception is the result of a conditioned reflex in focusing, which, in turn, is the result of the aforementioned anesthesia.

At the beginning of such a path, if you were to listen into yourself, you would probably hear nothing. You would be convinced that there is nothing but emptiness. Or, perhaps, you would hear occasionally the voice of the childish, demanding, negative self. And then, of course, you are being convinced that this is your final reality. This frightens you, and you avoid facing the negative self even more until, perhaps, you learn with outer aid to make room for deeper, as yet unheard levels of inner reality.

Only as you question and challenge this negative voice; as you deal with it on a level of self-confrontation; as you identify it without being identified with it; as you learn not to allow it to control you, not to act it out even though you recognize the existence of this voice of selfishness and meanness; only as this attitude becomes consistent in deed; as confrontation between the lower self and the conscious, reasonable ego self with its goodwill, takes place constantly; only as you do all this again and again will you eventually find your focus on another level of consciousness, which you will suddenly discover has always been there.

The voice of God has always spoken to you, as it continues always to speak to you, always in a new way, always in a way adapted exactly to what you need most at any given moment in your life. It is an ongoing voice that you have overlooked and focused away from so that you are left with the illusion of silence. (By "you" I mean, of course, mankind as a whole in its mass conditioning.) Now, it is impossible to focus "back" to this beautiful voice by avoiding or skipping over that confrontation with the lower self that also always speaks to you. Your ego has to learn to distinguish between them. The voice of the lower self says, "I want it for me. I do not care about others." That part of you believes in a division and mutual exclusivity of interests between you and others so that it must have its own at the expense of others. That part has no connection with the reality that you can have all without depriving others. That voice must be confronted, it must be questioned. The voices of meanness and malice must be questioned, as must your stake in seeing others as bad and not wishing to make room for even a doubt in this regard. At the same time, you -- or that part of you -- doubt the beauty and trustworthiness of the universe. The voice of fear with its lack of faith must be questioned and confronted and dealt with. All these voices must be dealt with. Only when they are confronted in a most sincere, total, and thorough way will the ongoing voice of God be heard. And then you will rediscover that it has always spoken clearly and beautifully although it could not push itself beyond your deliberate focusing away from it.

Focusing is deliberate both in a positive and in a negative sense. In a positive sense, in the way I explained in this lecture, you had to be born in and with this anesthesia, having forgotten what you know, in order to purify totally all aspects of the self. Had you always heard the divine voice, that purification could not take place. You would not even have been able to focus on the negative

part and thus deal with it. It would have been quieted down and swept along. So in that sense, your focusing away from the divine voice is the anesthesia that your total self has deliberately decided upon for the incarnatory process.

In the negative sense, the deliberate focusing away from the divine voice is due to the strength and the power you give to the negative self that does not want any other rule and law but its own. The negative self does not want to know itself, yet the divine voice leads the negative self to know itself. That is the first step for the negative self to purify itself.

So, perhaps many of my friends on this path can now begin to take deliberate steps toward hearing distinctly both voices. What is the negative, lower self? It may manifest under a clever disguise. And what is the divine voice? You can deliberately learn to shift your focus, and you can now spend time in your meditation to learn this differentiation.

You will note, my friends, that for a long time the main aspect focused on in meditation was what I called impressing. In one of the basic lectures about meditation (Lecture No. 194), I spoke about both aspects: impressing and expressing -- instructing, claiming, conditioning, recreating, on the one hand; listening, hearing, and receiving, on the other. Now the time has come when you can safely focus more deliberately on expressing. You can learn to listen to the whole, wonderful universe, which is an ongoing, alive phenomenon. You dwell in this universe, and it dwells in you. You can discover it by focusing on it. You can awaken out of your dream state, out of your anesthesia, my friends. You can become truly alive and know the aliveness that is in you.

Are there any questions?

QUESTION: Yes. Most of my life I have been listening to my negativity. The negativity has been conducting me. This negativity is excessive control and contempt. Going from that lower voice, which has been such a large element in my personality, to trying to listen to the other part, let's say the sweet part of myself, the child's voice that was squashed, I am afraid that I will then not deal with the negativity, that I will go overboard and be false and not go into the negative parts.

ANSWER: That is always the danger, that is always the difficulty in the groping. Exactly that element of wishful thinking that the positive voice is now the only reality in the self must be taken into consideration, and then self-deception will no longer present a danger. It is possible to hear the divine voice in many areas, yet the negative self still exists.

The ego's block against recognition of the latter makes it impossible for the former to come through in regard to those specific areas. If, however, the ego specifically requests wisdom from the divine part of the self in order more deeply to recognize and find the best way to deal with the unpurified aspects, the divine voice will be heard and can be applied to where it is indeed most needed.

On this path, you have a number of good tools to help you avoid the danger of overlooking the undesirable aspects of yourself even when you begin to awaken the wisdom and the splendor of your divine reality. You learn again and again that one does not eliminate the other; you learn to deal with apparent contradiction; you learn to keep a record of your disharmonies in your daily review; you learn the power of repeated impressing in meditation that you do want to be aware of

every aspect your inner path wants you to be aware of at any given phase. By using all these tools, you can strengthen your determination to see and observe the undesirable and yet elicit the glory of God in you, listen to it, get to know it.

Another good tool is to pay heed to your reactions. Assess them according to how you feel. If you are truly in joy and brightness, if you are free of anxiety and in a happy state, then, in that particular moment, you are truly in touch with your divinity. And your inner path does not invite you at that particular time to deal with anything else. But maybe the next day something blurs the picture. Some unhappiness comes to you -- doubts, heaviness, anxiety. That is the sign that there is something you are overlooking. Your life manifestation is an inevitable and reliable gauge that shows whether you are overlooking what should be dealt with and are living in self-deception or whether you are truly following your path according to your plan. Examine your state of fulfillment in your relationships, your partnership, your work, your pleasures, your inner state of joyousness and peace and your outer state of fulfillment and abundance. These are gauges. To whatever degree there is unfulfilled longing, you know that there is something that you do not focus on.

Also, if you realize that, the divine voice will not lead you astray and away from where you should focus. This happens, or seems to happen, only when the ego has a strong intentionality in this. It will not tell you beautiful stories about your already purified part or about generalities. It will much rather point with love and firmness to exactly where you have to go. But your ego self must want that and must ask for it. If you humbly ask the best in yourself: "What do I need to see in myself? Where am I still blind? What can you tell me?," and if you really want the truth and you open yourself, it will instruct you in the most marvelous way. Nothing can strengthen your faith more in the truth of God's existence than this connection with God. Then you create a unification. The teaching you receive from within you will be a tremendously strengthening and unifying experience so that listening to the beautiful voice will not get you away from the unpurified part, but rather it will bring both parts together so that the negative part will transform itself and become part of the Godself. You see, the manifestation will be exactly a result of your intention. If you want to use the voice of beauty in order not to deal with the ugliness, you will hear only beauty. You will hear what your ego consciousness is ready to receive. The divine voice cannot manifest in any other way.

QUESTION: I have difficulties in interpreting the messages that I receive and in believing in them. I receive messages, but it is only later that I realize that I did. I don't realize it on time.

ANSWER: That is the learning process I spoke about. Only by experience, by selection, by assessment, and by trial and error can you learn to understand the laws here. There are certain rules, in broad outline. Those who have gone through this process extensively can be helpful, as, for example, the instrument through whom I manifest. However, even that is limited. For every person is different, has different leanings, may have different weak points of wishful thinking. And you will be tested in terms of the extent to which you really have to grope and learn and question yourself. The most valuable treasure a human being can possess -- the connection with the divine voice -- cannot be handed ready-made on a silver platter. It must be earned through the groping process. You must learn to question yourself about the extent to which wishful thinking may possibly be coloring the reception. On the other hand, beware of the equal danger of the opposite. To what extent does the fear of wishful thinking color the reception and obstruct the truth that would only be too welcome? If the voice says something that is so desirable that you do not dare to believe it, it

may still be true. But you must test it out and explore your inner self as to whether there exists any desire to cheat, to avoid something that is necessary for you, and so on. Only experience in a deep, inner way will teach you and give you the security. You must try again and again. You must listen, give it attention, take it seriously, but also not be gullible, and realize that tests must come in order for you to learn what needs to be learned.

If you discover the voice only after the fact, that too is all right. It is then up to you to deal with it, to think back how it was that you heard it. You can meditate for enlightenment, and slowly you will learn the process. If there were hard and fast rules, that security would not come. It can come only through the process of groping, learning, making mistakes. Eventually the inner knowing will come. You will have the feeling deep inside in your center where it will feel right and good, and you will know that this is it, and you will learn to trust it.

Now, my dearest friends, I bless all of you. Divine love and wisdom are here in abundance. You who work on this path create so much blessing for yourself, so much light. More and more you will awaken from your sleep so that you will never have to fall asleep again. Rest will not impair the awareness of a joyous, peaceful, exciting, blissful universe in which you live and which lives in you. You are blessed.

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